GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

April 11th, 2025
Week 15
Volume 271, Issue 1180

Highlights:

- **Volatile week.**
- **Stock surge/plunge.**
- **Tariffs rule.**
- **90 day pause.**
- **Extension due.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Victory has a hundred fathers, but defeat will always be an orphan."

– Anonymous

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

TARIFF TAINTED!

An extremely volatile week of tariff announcements, suspensions, mishandling of economic affairs and fluctuating markets has left Indian sub-continent ship recycling destinations on edge, fearful of the next moves by a seemingly irrational & aggressive Trump regime. Indeed, global stock markets declined nearly 20% and lost over USD 11.2 Trillion, only to appreciate by about 10% in the days following the announcement of a 90-day suspension on all tariffs to nearly all countries worldwide. While most of the world watched on in silence to see it all play out, the EU and China responded in kind placing counter-tariffs against the United States resulting in the stock markets continuing their decline despite Pres. Trump reversing course mid-week. His tit-for-tat act with China too shows no signs of abating as about 125% in duties have been placed by China so far while counter-tariffs to the tune of 145% have been levied by the United States. Reportedly, Trump's tariff backtracks erupted on the back of a massive sell-off of U.S. Treasury Bonds (the **Gold** standard of currency for the U.S. Federal Government) from the Japanese market that caused the Team Trump to panic, resulting in his administrations erratic actions through this week. For the sub-continent ship recycling markets however, the key driver will be just how hard steel prices / non-ferrous steel trade will be hit when it comes time for ship-recyclers to sell their product.

Although the 90-day suspension seems to have given recyclers some reprieve for the time being, the deadline realistically stands a mere quarter away. In the interim, oil has volleyed like a beach ball in the wind, declining all the way to USD 56/barrel mid-week (lowest levels seen since 2020), before climbing back up to USD 61.50/barrel where it ended the week, and future declines are still expected as OPEC+ countries re-affirmed their decision to increase output despite tit-for-tat trade wars raising global economic uncertainty and rising lack of energy demands abound. Even the U.S. Dollar spiked briefly against all ship recycling nation currencies before settling down with a surprising result, where even the Lira made decent gains against the Dollar. And global trade markets too continued to take a dunk in the tariff pool as freight rates cooled, although they did even out towards the end of the week and report minor gains. What comes of this dip in rates remains to be seen since no fresh tonnage has made its way onto the bidding tables of late. And this has demonstrated itself in plain sight at the respective anchorages this week as India (technically) reports its first 'empty' report, while Pakistan impressively takes in the most tonnage in the sub-continent. Through it all, Turkey continues to idle in stand-by, waiting for the opportune moment to set into gear – as long as there is some tonnage to feed into **any** of the markets at this time.

Finally, for those facilities (especially ones with incoming deliveries over the next tides) who are to initiate yard upgrades to HKC standards in Bangladesh and have failed to do so just yet, the possible extension from the March 31st decline is expected to come through next week once the nation returns from the longest Eid Holiday on record, and the Ministry of Industries has passed the requisite file over to the newly formed Ship Recycling Board in order to coordinate any extension further. With HKC deadline expected on 26 June this year along with the Trump regime re-visiting the tariffs shortly thereafter, 2024 seems as though it may have just been a ripple in a pool that's slow drained itself into the rapids of 2025, especially if long-term tariffs come into effect and / or worse yet, a large(er) than expected number of ship recyclers fail to make the HKC cut and have to shut shop.

BANGLADESH

EXTENSION EXPECTED.

Not yet in place.

Despite local rumors that the Department of Environment had approved an extension to the March 31st deadline within which, Chattogram yard owners must have initiated the necessary upgrades to ensure their ship recycling facilities are conforming to the standards & requirements of the HKC within June 26th of this year, this does not seem to have been the case as this Department has no jurisdiction over NOC issuances and SRFP extensions, instead only being concerned with annual yard permissions and vessel visits to local ports. In fact, the Ministry of Industries has been occupied with the transfer of responsibilities to the newly formed Ship Recycling Board and it is this department that is expected to grant said extension upon their return from Eid Holidays next week, especially as the fate of several incoming vessels / deliveries for the upcoming tide(s) hang(s) in the balance.

Ministry at work.

Meanwhile, there has not been much of meaningful economic or political news emanating from the country over the last couple of weeks due to ongoing religious celebrations across the nation, which have reportedly been the longest in the nation's history. And in keeping in line with religious traditions, record-breaking incoming personal remittances and monetary gifts helped boost the nation's domestic reserves to well over USD 21 Billion, further facilitating Bangladesh's foreign exchange and treasury reserves. Similar to India, this will only help ensure domestic recyclers have a steady stream of finance / funding needed to help with purchases (current and future) that are still ongoing, even in the face of a declining supply of recycling tonnage, which is clearly evident from this week's arrivals where 2 really small units greeted Chattogram's anchorage.

Price woes.

And with fundamentals and international tariff news keeping local prices in check for the most part, especially as the Trump administration announced 30% tariffs on Bangladesh and reversed course on them days later, resulted in the Bangladeshi Taka strengthening against the U.S. Dollar and ending the week 13 basis points stronger at BDT 121.76. On account of the local holidays, local steel plate prices too have logically remained flatlined (on account of the lack of domestic steel trade) and remained where they have been for a while now (USD 529/Ton). This has delivered a confusing time for Bangladeshi recyclers post Eid holidays – with local indications and demand nosediving on the back of global tariff announcements, before coming surging back up to current levels once the 90-day suspension was announced.

HKC + Tariffs

Overall, with deadline extensions expected for yards that have not begun improving their facilities in order to keep operating when the Hong Kong Convention comes into force on June 26th this year, along with the 90 day pause on tariffs that could rear its head up against the local economy from July, will all come wet-wrapped in the midst of a likely crazy monsoon that certainly doesn't bode for a meaningful Q2 in Bangladesh.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

RESPECTING RELATIONS!

Despite all of the unfolding tariff drama across the world, Alang has been remarkably unaffected for the most part, especially as the Indian government had played it strategically with Trump even before he took office on January 20th, when PM Modi made several visits to the U.S. in order to address future trade between the nations. And although tariffs were initially imposed on India, the 90-day pause in addition to ongoing bilateral discussions between the administrations is likely to yield far greater results for the Indian economy post July, especially given how tenaciously volatile 2025 has already proven itself to be thus far. With January – February flooding the markets with units to a seriously muted supply of tonnage through March – April, which has left India devoid of any fresh arrivals at the waterfront this week, with the only vessel idling outside being an arrival from last week that is still awaiting delivery.

Seemingly unaffected.

Meanwhile, the Indian Rupee, which has been a bane for local recyclers, continues its predictably volatile dance against the U.S. Dollar as it lost 80 basis points and ended the week at Rs. 86.05, having nearly approached Rs. 87 by mid-week. Even local steel plate prices fell by about USD 6/Ton overall, despite having made a recovery towards the end of the week. This has seen some local concern about what happens to these fundamentals from next week as the U.S. – China tit-for-tat tariff twitter-spat has yet to find a middle ground before imported steel plate prices can find stable footing once again, especially now that Chinese steel plate levels themselves plummeted over USD 15/Ton this week and ended the week at USD 293/Ton, well below their usual playing field of USD 300/Ton.

Steel key.

Logically, elevated local concerns about the potential dumping of cheaper products into India and competing markets due to a flood of cheap Chinese billets and far cheaper Chinese steel, which ship recyclers will have to contend with and this will more than likely drag vessel prices down with them, even though local punitive measures to prevent any undercutting is already in place. For now, despite assertions of a special relationship with the Trump regime, India will likely still be subject to its share of tariffs under new U.S. decrees even though the 90 day pause on activity may give recyclers a short window to import vessels, all while Pakistan continues to take larger slices of the available tonnage pie.

Short window.

On the HKC front, and unlike their competing neighbours, Alang recyclers are full prepared for the advent of the HKC as local authorities have even gone to the extent of aligning necessary paperwork and formalities on all incoming vessels post June 26th, something that was highlighted in a previous edition of the GMS Weekly (ask us for a copy). On the domestic front, other than the ongoing deliverance of American financial hiccups, not much has changed with India's economy over the last week as all key figures and trajectories are still pointing in the right direction. Q3 seems like it is gearing up to be one of the busiest times for the Alang market, especially considering how 2025 is playing out so far.

Busy Q3?

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

INSULATED?

Slim pickings.

Despite Pakistan emerging as a viable ship recycling destination once again, the supply has trickled down to slim pickings of vessels on the bidding tables that have primarily been geographically positioned Far Eastern units, which remain better suited heading to a far more bullish Bangladeshi market, as trading markets / freight rates start to favor ship owners all over again - even on vintage / over-aged tonnage. As such, there have only been a handful of mostly regionally owned vessels of smaller LDT units heading to Gadani recyclers, even though demand is there to acquire any larger units that may come available. And with their firmer (than India) prices on show and even firmer indications coming forth this week, it was no surprise to see this market conclude the most tonnage in the sub-continent as local recyclers took in more LDT than neighboring Indian and Bangladeshi anchorages combined.

Smaller LDT.

Local fundamentals, meanwhile, remain in a state of flux as not only have local steel plate prices finally settled (after falling over USD 40/Ton over March) at USD 624/Ton over the last couple of weeks, but the Pakistani Rupee Pakistan also resumes its slow devaluing trudge against the U.S. Dollar after it briefly gained a lot of ground mid-week, yet lost 10 basis points overall and declined to PKR 280.06 as the week ended.

And just like the rest of the world, Pakistan has not been entirely insulated from the now-suspended tariff wars that are largely playing out between the U.S. and China, in an increasingly retaliatory manner. Yet, all eyes will be firmly placed on the next moves from either side, as this unpredictable drama surely has its share of twists and turns yet to come, especially for the Indian sub-continent steel and ship recycling markets, given that Chinese steel plate has already plummeted about USD 15/Ton this week and the fear is that cheaper competitive steel products will imminently flood this market causing steel trade between domestic ship recycling yards and local steel mills to be severely affected and likely result in further declining Paksitani steel values.

Eyes locked.

In the interim, local recyclers have bigger fish to fry as with pending HKC upgrades from a bulk of domestic ship recycling yards are yet to commence at pace and this will have even greater implications for Gadani ship recyclers in a post Q3 world as not only will local recyclers be barred from importing vessels for recycling, but the tariff wars are also expected to resume, which could affect the nation's economy moving forward. With monsoons being in full swing at that time and India leading Pakistan on the pricing chart more often than not, a healthy collection of Gadani ship recyclers might have to rapidly make amends in order to continue operating in a post June 26th world, or simply shut shop.

8,000 points.

Overall, despite the Pakistani stock exchange plunging over 8,000 points on the back of economic hiccups experienced throughout the week, the nation's financial position remains in decent standing and able to assist local recycling purchases through the interim.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

WAIT…WHAT?!?!

One eye open.

The Turkish market really surprised industry players this week as a myriad of fundamentals defied explanation and reacted contrary to how much of the industry reacted to Trumps tariff tantrum this week as on the one hand, both local and import steel plate prices declined by USD 10/ton and USD 20/Ton respectively, but the Turkish Lira amazingly ended the week on a positive note, having firmed 10 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and closing the week out at a still whopping / record breaking TRY 37.94.

The supply of vessels to Aliaga, like the rest of the industry, remains lament-worthy, as does the number of available recyclers who are still operating with one eye open. Mercifully, the 90 day pause on tariffs should help keep local offerings where they are…for now.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 15 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	450 / LDT	470 / LDT	480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Improving**	445 / LDT	465 / LDT	475 / LDT
3	India	**Improving**	440 / LDT	460 / LDT	470 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Stable**	280 / LDT	290 / LDT	300 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *A tick bite can make you allergic to mammalian meat—so much so that some ranchers are becoming allergic to their own cattle.*
- *When some people took a drug originally approved to treat asthma, their food allergies also started disappearing.*
- *Brains have a consistency not unlike tapioca pudding.*
- *The weight of giant pumpkins increased 20-fold in half a century.*
- *Kids don't really need to eat vegetables.*
- *You can give rice a nutty flavor by growing cow cells inside the grains.*
- *Mushroom genes can make petunias glow.*
- *In the Middle Ages, people took their pet squirrels for walks and decked them out in flashy accessories.*
- *You can buy a fitness tracker for your pet.*
- *Humankind has basically reached the limit of airplane-overhead-bin space.*
- *Study-abroad accents might be real.*
- *Each clan of sperm whales uses its own set of clicking sounds to communicate. Some of these sounds may be older than Sanskrit.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 14 – Dr. Ambedkar Jayanti April 18 – Good Friday April 20 – Easter Sunday	April 12 – April 17 April 26 – May 03

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 14 – Bengali New Year	April 12 – April 15 April 27 – April 30

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
May 01 – 05 – Labor Day May 31 – June 02 – Dragon Boat Holiday	May 01 – Labor Day	April 23 – National Sovereignty & Children's Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of April 11, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Athena	1,178	Supply Vessel	Arrived April 03
Total Tonnage		**1,178**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of April 11, 2025

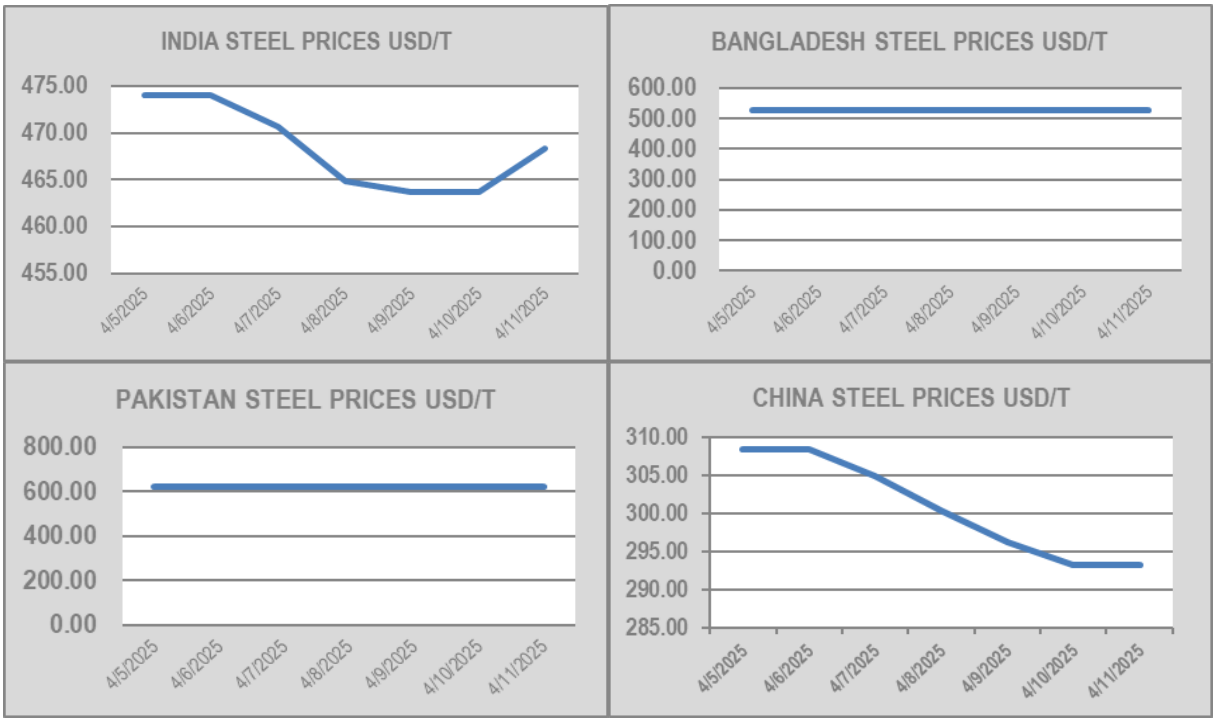
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Jarucha 6	975	General Cargo	Arrived April 10
2	*King Hung No. 2*	*948*	*Tanker*	*Delivered April 10*
3	*Rich Anna*	*1,011*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered April 10*
		2,933		

GADANI - Port Position as of April 11, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	DSM Star	8,000	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 02
2	Sea Wise	5,533	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 09
Total Tonnage		**13,533**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
4/5/2025	474.01	40,400.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	308.57
4/6/2025	474.01	40,400.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	308.57
4/7/2025	470.64	40,400.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	304.95
4/8/2025	464.87	40,100.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	300.54
4/9/2025	463.72	40,200.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	296.26
4/10/2025	463.72	40,200.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	293.38
4/11/2025	468.33	40,300.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	293.38



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